

W013437-091426 - California Public Records Request

Message History (3)

On 9/21/2026 9:25:01 AM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:

Subject: California Public Records Request :: W013437-091426

Body:

RE: PUBLIC RECORDS REQUEST of September 14, 2026, Reference # W013437-091426

Dear Brian C,

The City received the following records request on September 14, 2026.

Public Records Request — basis for the September 2, 2026 redaction of "Homicide/Death" from a search-audit Reason field, and records reconciling that redaction with unredacted Reason-field content in prior productions

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act (Gov. Code § 7920.000 et seq.), I request the following records from the San Mateo Police Department.

This request seeks existing records only (Gov. Code § 7922.530; Sierra Club v. Superior Court (2013) 57 Cal.4th 157).

Context

As you are aware, on September 2, 2026, in its determination on request W013308-082426, the Department produced a search-audit record for search ID 9920424e-bfd0-4f87-8423-6abce941fdc7 (search time 03/05/2026, 10:15:07 PM UTC) in which the words "Homicide/Death" were redacted from the Reason field while the word "Investigation" was left visible. Government Code section 7922.540 requires that a determination withholding any portion of a responsive record be in writing and state the exemption relied upon. No exemption was cited for that redaction and no redaction log or field-specific determination accompanied the production.

The Department's own prior productions contain Reason-field values that name the same or closely related content without redaction:

- In the audit record for December 2025, produced under request W012541-041426, the Reason field for search ID eb6a27e9-e279-46dc-ac67-2a8453f5db49 (search time 12/04/2025, 12:18:51 AM UTC) reads "Homicide suspect vehicle" in full, unredacted.*
- In the audit record for February 2024, produced under request W012541-041426, the Reason field for search ID 4e36944b-c3f6-4638-abc5-ad1f2bf4ff00 (search time 02/13/2024, 03:54:50 AM UTC) reads "Homicide" in full, unredacted. The same value appears unredacted for search IDs 366e9097-2ca0-479f-9c6e-7b461bec7ab8 and 2c548058-7bd1-47d3-9a00-b4bd410ae934 in the same production.*
- In the audit record for May 2026, produced under request W012818-053026, the Reason field for search ID 3fe27ecb-7891-4411-8ac9-d92ebaddf2b5 (search time 05/13/2026, 02:53:55 PM UTC) reads "Homicide/Death Investigation" in full, unredacted.*

Records requested

1. Exemption basis for the September 2, 2026 redaction. The Government Code section 7922.540 determination, or any other record reflecting the exemption relied upon, redaction log, review note, or exemption worksheet, for the redaction of "Homicide/Death" from the Reason field of the search-audit record for search ID 9920424e-bfd0-4f87-8423-6abce941fdc7, produced September 2, 2026 under request W013308-082426. If no responsive record exists, please affirm the search performed.

2. Basis for treating Reason-field homicide references as exempt, or not. Any record reflecting a determination, standard, or criteria the Department applies to decide whether Reason-field content referencing a homicide or death investigation is exempt from disclosure under Government Code § 7923.600 — including any record explaining why the Reason-field values identified above, in the Department's own productions of the December 2025 and February 2024 audit records (request W012541-041426) and the May 2026 audit record (request W012818-053026), were released without redaction, if the Department's position is that Reason-field content of that kind is generally exempt.

3. Correction, if any. If the Department's position is that the September 2, 2026 redaction was made in error, or alternatively that the Reason-field values identified above should also have been redacted, a written statement to that effect.

If no records are located for any individual item, please respond to that item separately and continue processing the remaining items.

Anticipated exemption issues

- Gov. Code § 7923.600. The records requested are records of the Department's own redaction and production decisions — exemption citations, redaction logs, review notes, and determinations — not investigatory files compiled in connection with any particular case.

- Segregability (Gov. Code § 7922.525(b)). If any individual record contains both responsive and exempt content, I request the reasonably segregable non-exempt portions after redaction.

If any portion is denied, please:

- 1. respond to that item separately and state the specific legal basis for the denial;**
- 2. provide specific exemption citations per Gov. Code § 7922.540;**
- 3. identify the withheld record type and volume; and**
- 4. continue processing the remaining items.**

Thank you.

Brian

A good faith and diligent search yielded no records responsive to your request. A response to your request can be found in the attachments of this request.

The City has completed its response to your request and we now consider this record request W013437-091426 closed. If you have any questions, or would like to submit a new request for records, please contact the

City.

If you have any questions, please contact me using the below contact information.

Sincerely,

Kelly O'Keefe
Police Technical Services Administrator
Police
(650) 522-7709

On 9/14/2026 3:10:48 PM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:



Thank you for your interest in public records of the City of San Mateo. Your request was received by the City of San Mateo on 9/14/2026 and given the reference number **W013437-091426** for tracking purposes.

Record(s) Requested: **Public Records Request — basis for the September 2, 2026 redaction of "Homicide/Death" from a search-audit Reason field, and records reconciling that redaction with unredacted Reason-field content in prior productions**

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the Reason field while the word "Investigation" was left visible. Government Code section 7922.540 requires that a determination withholding any portion of a responsive record be in writing and state the exemption relied upon. No exemption was cited for that redaction and no redaction log or field-specific determination accompanied the production.

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2. provide specific exemption citations per Gov. Code § 7922.540;
3. identify the withheld record type and volume; and
4. continue processing the remaining items.

Thank you.

Brian

The request is being forwarded to appropriate department(s) for processing.

Monitor request progress at the link below. The City will email you when the request is complete. Thank you for using the San Mateo Records Center.

To monitor the progress or update this request please log into the [San Mateo Records Center](#).

On 9/14/2026 3:10:47 PM, Brian C wrote:

Request Created on Public Portal